

SOCIO-ECONOMIC UPLIFT

- Financial aid under the Mukhyamantri Vivah Shagun Yojana has been increased, with up to ₹71,000 for SC/ST women and ₹51,000 for widowed or destitute women, ensuring marriage support for disadvantaged groups.
- Self-employment support has been enhanced, with financial assistance raised to ₹80,000 for eligible individuals for promoting small business ownership and self-reliance.
- Educational access has improved, with digitisation of scholarship schemes and relaxed income and academic criteria under the Ambedkar Medhavi Scholarship Scheme.
- Legal and social justice provisions have expanded, including ₹22,000 legal aid support and compensation up to ₹8.25 lakh for victims under the SC/ST Atrocities Act.
- Inclusivity measures now cover a wider range of communities, with the addition of new groups to the SC list, the creation of dedicated commissions for SCs, Backward Classes, Safai Karamcharis, and targeted support for nomadic tribes.

In another progressive move, the government has raised the amount for SC/ST beneficiaries to ₹71,000, and for the widows, destitute, or legally separated women to `51,000, making marriage less financially burdensome for many families.

Inclusion has also become central, with dedicated provisions for persons with disabilities. Since June 3, 2020, the state has offered marriage incentives to couples where one or both partners are physically challenged. If both have disabilities, they receive ₹51,000, while couples with one physically challenged partner are entitled to ₹41,000, ensuring dignity and support for differently abled individuals.

PROMOTING ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND SELF-RELIANCE

The government has made significant progress in promoting entrepreneurship and self-reliance. Under the Self-Employment Scheme, the assistance amount for setting up small business was increased from ₹50,000 to ₹80,000 from April 1, 2021. On August 12, 2024, provisions were introduced to extend the financial aid to ₹80,000 for eligible candidates, giving wings to their aspirations to start small businesses and achieve self-sufficiency.

Promoting social harmony through inter-caste marriages remains a key priority. Since September 20, 2019, couples entering into inter-caste union have been awarded a total financial incentive of ₹2.5 lakh. Of this, ₹1.25 lakh is deposited directly into the couple's joint bank account, while the remaining ₹1.25 lakh is kept as a fixed deposit for three years—a considered approach aimed at ensuring stabilityand security for such newlyweds as challeng societal barriers.

Access to justice has also been streamlined and made accessible. Through the Legal Aid Scheme, implemented from June 21, 2021, eligible individuals receive financial assistance of ₹22,000 to support legal proceedings—a crucial intervention for those facing discrimination or injustice. For victims of caste-based atrocities such as illegal land occupation, violence, sexual assault, or mob attacks, the state provides financial compensation ranging from ₹85,000 to ₹8.25 lakh, provided an FIR is filed under the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989.

Education, as a long-term tool of empowerment, continues to receive strong support. The state has digitised its Post-Matric Scholarship Scheme for SCs, Denotified Tribes, and Backward Classes. Applications can now be submitted online via the Har- Chhatravratti portal, making the process transparent and accessible. Similarly, the Dr B.R. Ambedkar Medhavi Chhatra Yojana has also been made online, encouraging more students to apply with ease.

AMBEDKAR MEDHAVI SCHOLARSHIP SCHEME

In order to benefit a wider student population, key reforms were introduced to the Ambedkar Medhavi Scholarship Scheme on September 15,

Haryana is ushering in a new era of social equity with a series of progressive welfare reforms. From enhanced marriage incentives and expanded self-employment support to digitised education schemes and strengthened legal aid, the state is addressing the needs of its most vulnerable citizens

